MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR /IMPROVEMENT/ REAPPEARANCE

EXAMINATION NOVEMBER 2025

FIRST SEMESTER

Multi-Disciplinary Courses (MDC) **- MG1MDCPSY100 - COMMUNICATE WITH CONFIDENCE**

Duration: 1.5 Hours **Maximum Marks: 50**

PART-A

1. Volume
2. Passive listening
3. Facial expression
4. Communication apprehension
5. Asynchronous communication
6. Tone
7. Non-verbal communication
8. Body of the presentation
9. Physical barriers
10. Audience analysis

PART- B

11. B) Encouraging bilingual employees to assist
12. C) Assertive
13. D) Collect thoughts and regain composure
14. A) establish emotional connection and trust
15. A) paralanguage
16. B) “To conclude…”
17. C) Perfectionism
18. C) learning to use the existing voice effectively
19. C) Compromising
20. B) Observing a model’s assertive communication

PART- C

21. Tables are not very effective when used in PowerPoint, except when they are very small. The size of the cells and the space available reduce readability. It is visually far more appealing to link the slide to a table in Word or Excel and show those in full screen and then jump back to the original screen.

22. **Eye contact**
    Just as a speaker should provide selective eye contact to the listeners, the listener should provide periodic and selective eye contact to the speaker. The same benefits of eye contact that apply to a speaker also apply to a listener.
    Posture

The best **posture** for effective listening is to sit bending a little forward. This shows a sense of anticipation.

If there is a table in front of you, leaning forward with your elbow every now and then will be a good posture for listening.

Make sure you don't get physically tired of whatever posture you choose. Else, your focus will only be on your physical discomfort and not on the subject matter you are listening to.

23. Emphasis of words is another important tool. When you have a sentence, not every word in the sentence is equally important. By emphasizing certain words, you can get the correct meaning across. If you utter all the words with the same stress, it becomes monotonous and each audience member could potentially walk away with totally different interpretations of your message. By emphasizing different parts of a sentence, very different meanings can be conveyed.

24. First—as in the case of posture—it **indicates your level of confidence-**
Second, **it determines how easily you can position yourself for effective use of gestur**es- When a person stands with very stiff hands, he will find it a serious hindrance to communication. He will not be able to move around freely and use other gestures. Also, he will appear cold, nervous and inflexible to the audience

25. Communication begets trust when the speaker has a pleasant smile on his or her face. A smile conveys a friendly disposition and creates a feeling of trust. In addition, physiologists have established that a smile relaxes more muscles in your body and hence, contributes to better physical comfort and therefore, to an increased sense of confidence.

26. Posture refers to how you stand or sit. This is a sure give-away of your attitude and confidence level. When you are standing straight and not slouching, it usually indicates a higher degree of confidence. When shoulders droop or when you are bending forward too much, it conveys a lack of confidence.

Posture also applies when you sit. Leaning forward while sitting down could indicate a more keen interest in the subject matter. When you extend the leaning forward to almost lying down on the table, it will obviously convey a reduced interest in the subject.

Whether you are sitting or standing, a good posture would:

Be comfortable for you
Demonstrate your active interest and confidence
Not hinder other communication vehicles (like gestures, movements, etc.)

27. In a very hierarchical and bureaucratic organization, information may have to flow through several channels. Hence, distortion through the various layers is possible. Also not all the relevant information may be available to a speaker, because of hierarchy. This may affect the thinking and formulation phases.

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- Be comfortable for you
- Demonstrate your active interest and confidence
- Not hinder other communication vehicles (like gestures, movements, etc.)

Eye contact is another important aspect by which a speaker can reach out to the audience and the listener can synch up with the speaker.

- From the point of view of a speaker, eye contact gives a great opportunity to reach out to the audience better. Looking into the eye of a listener gives the speaker a possible insight into the listener's state of mind and how the listener is disposed towards the message.
- The amount of eye contact a speaker needs to give each member of the audience can be an indication of the importance of that member vis-à-vis the other members. By balancing the duration of eye contact and the specific instances of eye contact to specific people, a speaker can increase the chances of getting the message across more effectively.

29. Time management is crucial to a presentation.

Ineffective time management, when a presenter spends an undue amount of time in a part of the presentation, can lead to insufficient time for the closure part and hence the audience may walk away with different notions than what were intended.

30. Synchronous communication can again be classified into **face-to-face communication and non-face-to-face communication**. The meetings you attend, the interviews you conduct, the presentations you make and the classes you conduct in the classroom are all examples of face-to-face, synchronous communication.

In the second category of synchronous communications **comes non-face-to-face synchronous communication. These are the telephone calls and the chat sessions that you have**. Here, you face all the challenges that you come across in the face-to-face case, with one more added challenge: you have lost those valuable cues of body language. You don't have any mechanism to fathom the implied meaning of any spoken word For example, you cannot look at the enthusiasm (or lack thereof) in the gestures and body language. You would not be able to look into the eyes of the recipient to make a judgement as to whether or not he is lying.

31. First, **for communication to qualify as interpersonal, at least two people must be involved.**

Second, **interpersonal communication is a process**. By this, we simply mean **that it usually involves a series of actions**: Kelli talks/Jason listens, Jason responds/Kelli listens, and so on.

Third, this process is **interactional**. Effective communication is not a one-way street: **Both participants send as well as receive information when they're interacting**.

Communicators also interpret and create messages by reflecting on their own experiences.

32. Communication establishes an ongoing relationship between two parties—the sender and the receiver: In most cases, communication is never a one-time deal.

There may be a series of interviews you would have to go through to get a job; you would almost never close a deal in one shot with a customer.

True communication is seldom a one-off transactional thing.

Every communication is made up of a series of communication cycles: Each of these cycles contributes to the objective, and builds upon the previous cycle.

Each communication cycle is a brick carefully laid with other bricks to achieve the objective of communication.

33. Communication apprehension, or ***anxiety caused by having to talk with others.***

- **Constantly practice**, do a thorough audience analysis and clearly understand your objectives of communication.
  Understand the **big picture,** know your role in it and take pride in it
- **Don't try to be a perfectionist**. Don't feel bad that you forgot the third point when you are talking about the seventh point—the audience would not know you had missed the third point unless you confessed to them
- **Don't take public speaking** (or any failure there of) as a reflection of your **actual self worth**—there is more to life than this! Once you take this pressure off your chest, you will feel lighter and less nervous.

PART- D

34. In role playing, you ask a friend or therapist to play the role of an antagonist, then practice communicating assertively in this artificial situation.

• Communicate freely. • Spontaneously. • Confidently in different situations.

Most interactions in our day to day lives are not engaging. As a result the audience i.e., the speaker and the listener tend to loose interest in the conversation. Thus to make a conversation interesting, a role play conversation methodology is adopted in order to make the communication more informative, and amusing.

• It helps in emotional feed-back • It helps in better physical performance • It helps in confidence building • It generates an environment of social responsibility and equity among the group • It enhances speaking skills • It also rebuilds an atmosphere of faith and calmness in a particular situation • For children role play is as essential as learning language • It encourages children towards emotional development • It enhances their language development • It also enhances their physical development.

35. There are certain important constituents of a good voice channel. These are:

- Pronunciation and Articulation - ***Pronunciation refers to your ability to utter the words in the same way as is considered standard***..
- **Articulation refers to coherence of the words and phrases in a talk**. When a person is articulate, the message would be easier to understand for the audience. **Articulation stems from proper pronunciation but is more than mere pronunciation**.

- Emphasis –When you are speaking, **not everyone in the audience tunes in to your speech the way you think they should**.
- Pace – **Pace refers to how fast you speak.**

In general, in many cases, **higher the pace of speech, the more persuasive it is.**
Higher pace gives an **aura of confidence** for the speaker but also gives **less opportunity for the audience to intervene**.

- Pitch- ***Pitch refers to how shrill your voice is – the baseline frequency of your voice.***

The pitch of your voice is dictated by the **thickness and length of your vocal chords.**
Each of our voices has **some limits** within which we can **'stretch' them.**
Too much of stretching will be **physically painful** for the speaker and may be jarring for the listener.

- Volume –***Volume refers to the loudness with which you speak.***

Some people **habitually speak so loud** that you wish you had a remote control button for controlling their volume!
At the other extreme are **people who talk so softly** that they can **barely be heard** even when you sit close to them. To be effective you need to strike a balance.
Volume goes in tandem with other parameters like speed, pitch, and articulation.

- Pause- **A good presentation should not be a continuous outpouring of words without any gaps.**

Periodic pauses during a presentation are essential. These enable you to recover your breath and also enable the audience to reflect on what you have said.

36. Some Special Usages and Features

1. Use of Icons and Pictures for Transitions

- Suppose you are going to present on the various functions served by the offices in San Francisco, London and Bangalore, you could put together a bulleted list.
- An alternative approach could be to show a world map. When the mouse is clicked on San Francisco, the functions of that office can be shown as a pop-up.

2. Use of Action Buttons

- PowerPoint provides a set of action buttons that can be used to control the movement through the various slides.
- Each slide can have a next, previous, first and home buttons.
- The next and previous buttons when clicked, can take you to the next or previous slide.
- The home button can be the transition to the first slide of the presentation, while the first could make the transition to the first slide of a given set.

3. Use of Embedded Objects

- Sometimes you may want to show an Excel spreadsheet or a Word document or some other object within a presentation. You can embed such an object within the presentation

4. Use of Tables

- In general, we feel that tables are not very effective when used in PowerPoint, except when they are very small.
- The size of the cells and the space available reduce readability.

37. Concept of Assertiveness

- Many people have a hard time being assertive; however, this **problem is more common among females** because **they are socialized to be more submissive than males**—to "be nice." Generally, **people tend to associate assertiveness with direct person-to-person social interactions**.
- Assertiveness is also important in **indirect exchanges** as well. Learning to be **assertive in email or text messages or on social networking sites** is also important.
- ***Assertiveness involves acting in one's own best interests by expressing one's thoughts and feelings directly and honestly.***
- Essentially, assertiveness involves **standing up for your rights** when someone else is about to infringe on them.
- ***Submissive communication*** is deferential, as it involves **giving in to others on points of possible contention**. Submissive people often **let others take advantage of them.**
- Typically, their biggest problem is that they **cannot say no to unreasonable requests.**
- A common example is the college student who can't tell her roommate not to borrow her clothes.
- Submissive people also have **difficulty voicing disagreement with others and making requests themselves**. In traditional trait terminology, they are timid.
- They appear to **lie in excessive concern about gaining the social approval of others.**
- ***Aggressive communication*** focuses on **saying and getting what one wants at the expense of others' feelings and rights.** With assertive behavior, however, **one strives to respect others' rights and defend one's own.**
- The problem in real life is that **assertive and aggressive behaviors may overlap.**

Assertiveness training is especially popular among women. **Men, too, find assertiveness training helpful**, both because some have been **socialized to be passive** and because **others want to learn to be less aggressive and more assertive.**